

UTT Chapter 02 Assignment

Hey there!

Intramurals have started up here at the university, and I've joined one of the soccer teams! I met a girl named Sarah (she's on my team), and we've chatted a few times. The other day after practice, I asked Sarah how her weekend was, and she said she had a great time clubbing with some friends on Saturday night. I asked her what she did on Sunday, and she laughed at me. I guess she stayed out so late that she didn't wake up until one or two p.m. Well, I was up much earlier than that. I did play quite a bit of ultimate Frisbee with my roommate on Saturday, but I wasn't too tired for church on Sunday morning. I guess Sarah doesn't go to church. She doesn't even believe in God. As a biochem major, she said she doesn't believe in anything she can't investigate with her five senses. As she put it, "If God existed, why hasn't he made himself known?"

I knew she was wrong. So I told her that God *has* made himself known—through Jesus Christ. That's how I know him! She smiled wryly and asked, "Have you ever seen him? Have you touched him? Have you heard him?" I didn't quite know how to respond to her. Of course I haven't seen God, but I still know he's real.

I told her that the most convincing element of Christianity for me is the evidence of my changed life. Through Christ, God saved me from my sin and ultimately from myself. She asked defensively if I thought everyone needed saving from sin and from themselves. Of course, I told her yes. Everyone needs Jesus.

She replied that she, for one, was doing just fine on her own. She told me she didn't think there was anything wrong with her, so there's nothing for God to fix. And she wondered why I would believe all this "Jesus talk" without any evidence that he actually exists.

I told her that's exactly what faith is; it's believing something in spite of the evidence. If we knew everything, we wouldn't need to have faith, right? She just laughed at me, shaking her head condescendingly. She told me that "blind faith" might work for Christians, but she would only believe in something if there were good evidence for doing so.

As you can see, I got myself into a bit of a bind. I know I have good reasons for believing everything I told her, but I am having trouble articulating it. I wonder if you could help! I know God has revealed himself, but **in what ways has God made himself known?** I was also confused when I told her why I need Jesus. I know we all need Jesus. I know we all sin, but **what's wrong with humanity?** And **what is God's plan for redeeming humanity?** Lastly, her comments about "blind faith" unsettled me as well. I've always thought that faith was blind, but I wish that it wasn't. **Is biblical faith really blind?** I hope you can help me out!

Gotta go! Bye!

–Doug